# Sharp Betting Models: Edge vs EV Conversation

Full transcript of discussion on modern elite sharp betting daily picks models.

## User

What do modern day elite sharp betting daily picks models optimize for, edge or EV?

## Grok

They optimize for positive expected value (+EV). In modern sharp/professional betting, “edge” and “EV” are tightly linked (often treated as essentially the same concept), but the precise optimization target for daily picks models is +EV.

How these models work Elite daily picks systems (proprietary statistical models, market-consensus tools, or hybrids) do the following:

1. Estimate a “true” or fair probability for an outcome (via their own model, de-vigged sharp book lines like Pinnacle/Circa/Novig, or a weighted blend of both). 2. Compare that probability to the implied probability from the available odds at soft or recreational books. 3. Calculate expected value (typically as a percentage of stake: EV = p × decimal_odds − 1, or the equivalent form accounting for profit/loss). 4. Select, rank, and often size bets only when EV is positive and clears a minimum threshold (commonly +2–5% or higher, depending on the market, volume, and model confidence). They frequently apply fractional Kelly sizing based on the size of that EV/edge.

“Edge” usually refers to the probability gap (model probability minus implied probability, in percentage points) or the resulting advantage. A positive edge at the actual price is exactly what produces positive EV. Many tools and services use the terms interchangeably (“find the edge,” “+EV spots,” “mathematical edge”). Slight technical distinctions exist—edge is often the probability differential, while EV is the expected monetary return that also depends on the odds—but models select and prioritize on the EV calculation.

What “elite/sharp” really emphasizes - +EV relative to sharp benchmarks is the core filter for daily picks. Tools scan for discrepancies between soft books and no-vig sharp consensus or model output, then surface ranked +EV opportunities. - Closing Line Value (CLV) is the main long-term validation metric. Consistently beating the closing line at sharp books is treated as proof the model captured real edge. Models are backtested and judged heavily on this. - Volume, line shopping, bankroll management, and avoiding limits matter operationally, but the pick-generation logic itself optimizes for positive EV.

In short, modern elite sharp daily picks models are built to identify and prioritize positive expected value. “Edge” is the common shorthand for that advantage; the math they optimize for is EV.

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What are the benchmarks they set for floors for these to make the daily card

## Grok

Modern elite sharp daily picks models typically set EV floors in the 2–3% range for general inclusion, with meaningful differences by market type. They rarely put every positive-EV opportunity on a curated “daily card.” Instead they apply floors plus other filters to keep the card focused on higher-confidence spots.

Common EV thresholds

Market type | Typical floor to make the card / be actionable | Rationale Main lines (spreads, totals, moneylines) | 0.5%–2% | Highly efficient; thin edges are still valuable at volume Player props & less liquid markets | 3%–6%+ | Higher variance and less reliable pricing; need a bigger buffer Curated daily card / “top picks” | Often 2–3% minimum, frequently higher | Quality over quantity; rank and further filter High-volume or automated approaches | Can go as low as ~1% or even 0.5% | Edge shows up only over large samples

Specific examples from tools and sharp practice: - Many disciplined bettors and tools (PropPrizm guidance, Parlayers, etc.) ignore anything under 3%. - Posit+EV shows only bets with ≥3% edge. - SharpAPI and similar recommend min_ev = 2 as a practical default; 2–5% is described as the solid “good” range. - Some prop-focused services use higher bars (e.g., 6% NBA / 8% NHL). - High-volume operators sometimes run lower floors (~1–3%) because volume compensates for thinner edges; manual or curated cards stay higher.

Additional filters that act as floors EV% is rarely the only gate. Models commonly also require: - Minimum number of sharp books agreeing on the fair price (or minimum market width / consensus strength). - Minimum sharp-book limits (e.g., Pinnacle limit thresholds) so the fair price has been tested by real money. - Odds range limits (avoid extreme longshots or heavy favorites where variance and pricing are noisier). - Upper EV caps (very large edges, often >10–15%, are frequently treated as stale lines, errors, or unconfirmed news rather than automatic includes). - Sport- and market-specific adjustments, plus sometimes confidence grades or additional signals (line movement, model calibration, historical CLV on similar spots).

How this shapes the daily card Most elite or professional-style daily picks are not “everything above X% EV.” They take the broader +EV pool, apply the floors above, then rank and further curate (often down to a small number of higher-confidence or higher-EV selections). The ultimate long-term benchmark remains consistent positive Closing Line Value (CLV) against sharp books, not just the initial EV percentage at the time of the pick.

In short, a practical floor for a quality daily card is usually around 2–3% EV (higher on props), combined with consensus and market-quality filters, rather than a pure minimum positive number.

## User

What about edge floors?

## Grok

Edge floors are not commonly used as a separate primary benchmark. Most modern elite sharp daily picks models set their floors on EV%, and “edge” is used loosely (or interchangeably) for the same thing.

Edge vs. EV in practice - Edge (probability points / pp): Model probability minus implied probability. Example: Model says 55%, book implies 52.4% at –110 → +2.6 pp edge. - EV%: Expected return as a percentage of stake. It incorporates both the probability gap and the odds/payout. The same +2.6 pp edge can produce

different EV% depending on the price.

Many tools and bettors still say “edge” when they mean the EV percentage (e.g., “3% edge”). When a model or service shows both, the filter that decides whether something makes the daily card is almost always the EV% number, not the raw probability-point gap.

Typical numbers when “edge” is treated as the floor When people or tools do talk about an edge floor in percentage terms, the practical ranges look like this:

Context | Common floor | Notes Main lines | ~1–3% (usually EV) | Thin edges are still playable with volume Player props | ~3–6%+ (usually EV) | Bigger buffer for variance and thinner markets Curated daily card | Often 2–3% minimum | Frequently higher or further ranked Probability-point style (less common) | ~2–5 pp | Seen more on some prop models; still usually translated into EV for sizing

Examples from current tools and sharp practice: - Posit+EV, PropPrizm guidance, and similar services use ≥3% as a common cutoff. - Many high-volume operators run lower (~1–3%) because volume compensates. - Very large apparent edges (often >10–15%) are frequently filtered or flagged as stale lines, errors, or unconfirmed news rather than automatic includes.

Bottom line There isn’t a widely standardized separate “edge (pp) floor” that elite daily picks models optimize against independently of EV. The actionable floor that determines whether a pick makes a quality daily card is almost always an EV% threshold (commonly 2–3% general, higher on props), often combined with the other filters covered earlier (consensus strength, sharp-book limits, odds range, etc.).

If a specific model or tool you use shows both “edge” and “EV,” the EV number is the one that drives the inclusion decision.

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